SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #117 · THE END TIMES

“Current events tell me exactly when the end is coming.”

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Where it often comes from

Prophecy teachers who connect news headlines to specific dates. Past predictions that seemed convincing. A desire for certainty in a frightening world. Social media full of end-times speculation. Anxiety that searches for signs.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture tells us to be watchful, but it is clear that no one knows the day or hour. Jesus said not even the angels know, only the Father. When the disciples asked about timing, Jesus said it is not for them to know times or seasons that the Father has fixed. The Day of the Lord will come like a thief in the night. Many confident predictions have come and gone. Our task is not to calculate the date but to be ready and faithful.

> *“No one knows about that day or hour, not even the angels in heaven, nor the Son, but only the Father”* **(Matthew 24:36)**.

Also see

> “Jesus replied, ‘It is not for you to know times or seasons that the Father has fixed by His own authority.’” **(Acts 1:7)**.

> “Therefore keep watch, because you do not know the day on which your Lord will come” **(Matthew 24:42)**.

> “For you are fully aware that the Day of the Lord will come like a thief in the night” **(1 Thessalonians 5:2)**.

> “You will hear of wars and rumors of wars, but see to it that you are not alarmed. These things must happen, but the end is still to come” **(Matthew 24:6)**.

Common self-statements

- This event proves the end is next year.
- I’ve figured out the timeline.
- I need to watch the news for every sign.
- The experts have calculated the date.
- If I miss the signs, I’ll be caught off guard.
- I can’t make plans because the end is so close.

Common logical errors

- **Overconfidence:** Believing you can know what Jesus said no one knows.
- **Confirmation bias:** Fitting every event into a predicted timeline.
- **Intolerance of uncertainty:** Needing to know exactly when.
- **Ignoring evidence:** Overlooking the many failed predictions of the past.

Challenging questions

- What did Jesus say about who knows the day or hour?

- What did Jesus tell the disciples when they asked about timing?
- How will the Day of the Lord come, according to 1 Thessalonians 5:2?
- How many past predictions have failed?
- Is watching the news increasing my faithfulness or my anxiety?
- What does being ready look like in everyday life?
- What would Jesus want me doing today?

Truth summary

> Current events do not tell me exactly when the end is coming. No one knows the day or hour except the Father. Jesus calls me to be watchful and ready, not to calculate dates. I can live faithfully today, trust God with the timing, and avoid being swept up by predictions.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- End Times
- Second Coming
- Truth
- Wisdom
- Anxiety/Worry

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Truth
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Current events tell me exactly when the end is coming"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Current events tell me exactly when the end is coming." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who knows the day or hour?
- ☐ What did Jesus say about knowing the times?
- ☐ How will the Day of the Lord come?
- ☐ How many predictions have failed?
- ☐ Is the news helping my faith or anxiety?
- ☐ What does being ready look like today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ No one knows the day or hour but the Father.
- ☐ My task is to be ready, not to calculate dates.
- ☐ God holds the times and seasons.
- ☐ I can live faithfully today.
- ☐ I don't have to follow every prediction.
- ☐ Jesus told me not to be alarmed.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Matthew 24:36**
  "No one knows about that day or hour, not even the angels in heaven, nor the Son, but only the Father."
- [ ] **Acts 1:7**
  "Jesus replied, 'It is not for you to know times or seasons that the Father has fixed by His own authority.'"
- [ ] **Matthew 24:42**
  "Therefore keep watch, because you do not know the day on which your Lord will come."
- [ ] **1 Thessalonians 5:2**
  "For you are fully aware that the Day of the Lord will come like a thief in the night."
- [ ] **Matthew 24:6**
  "You will hear of wars and rumors of wars, but see to it that you are not alarmed. These things must happen, but the end is still to come."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Faithful today log:** Each day, write one way I lived faithfully instead of searching for signs.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Matthew 24:42 becomes: "Therefore **Sarah** should keep watch, because **she** does not know the day on which **her** Lord will come."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Second Coming" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read Matthew 24:36–51,** and write what Jesus says faithful servants are doing when He returns.
- ☐ **Unfollow or mute one source** of end-times date-setting.
- ☐ **Look up three past predictions of the end** that did not come true.
- ☐ **Plan something good for next year,** trusting God with the timing.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Current events tell me exactly when the end is coming": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One faithful act today
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Current events tell me exactly when the end is coming.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that You hold the times and seasons. Help me reject the lie that current events tell me exactly when the end is coming. Keep me watchful and ready, faithful in today's work, and free from fear and speculation. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.